



The Field Guide
to Creating

Great Reports

The Point

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Set Your North

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Chart the Journey

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Principle 03
The Dual Lens

This Field Guide defines what separates a great report from a standard one. It is built around a **set of principles** that shape how a standout report should come together.

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Principle 04
The Reader's Roadmap

These principles bring together **narrative, design** and **production** to ensure your report does more than just present information. It should communicate direction, tell a coherent story, and make the company's performance and ambition easy to grasp.

Alongside these core principles, the Guide also offers practical advice on what to avoid best practices in printing, and the evolving role of digital innovation in reporting.

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Principle 05
The Compass, Not the Map

The aim is not to produce more pages, but better ones; reports where the story is clear, the design supports the message, and the final outcome is both engaging to read and look at.

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More Tips to Ensure Your Report Succeeds

Set your North

From the first glance, your company's **core message** and vision for the year should be evident. A strong, clear and compelling **theme line**, shaped by the company's performance and strategy for the year, together with an equally evocative **cover design**, enable this and set the direction for your report. This direction should be reinforced early through a concise theme introduction that explains the relevance of the theme.

The cover and its visual language are strategic design tools. They should uniquely represent the theme, using an engaging style that brings the concept to life.

Ultimately, 'Setting Your North' ensures your report is one that people actually want to read. By pairing a distinctive design with a title that is both clear and interesting, you **capture the reader's attention** at the 'zero moment of truth'—the exact moment they either decide to open and engage with your work, or move on.

Principle

Theme Line (Cover Title)

Introduction to the Theme

Concept

Cover Design

01

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